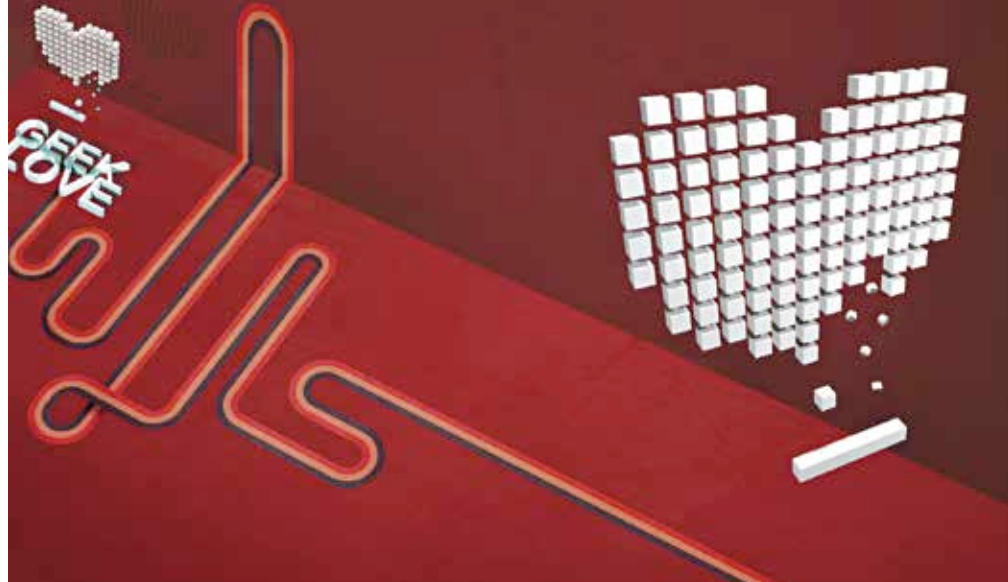




Credit: Rosaura Ochoa via Flickr

Roses are red, violets are blue, I love Star Wars - so do you!

WHAT MAKES A GEEK A GEEK

Popular culture would have us believe that being geeky is genetic – the staple of American movies, which pigeonhole what a notion of a geek is are the perfect example. However, it is unclear if being a geek is genetic. Studies assert that genes make a difference to one's intelligence levels and determine the individual's performance. However, they are not limited to determining one's IQ, but also fuel a person's motivation levels. Theories abound that people are just born with the natural affinity towards a certain activity, which they master and become experts at. So, while someone may be a techie, that is, working in the IT field, he or she may not necessarily be a geek.

There also exists a belief that all geeks wear glasses, drop out of college, and are too arrogant to work with others. While this may have been true for the older generation of geeks, the modern era geeks (you Digit readers included), are well-groomed, very well educated, articulate and driven, which is the reason why more and more geeks are finding success in the world. The geek shall inherit the earth?

People like Steve Jobs, Dennis Ritchie and Bill Gates are geeks who people admire and consider role models. These individuals changed the world and the modern geeks want to carry the torch forward by creating even more amazing products and services. Geeks are fast dispelling the prevalent notions and are the harbingers of change, especially in tech-related fields.

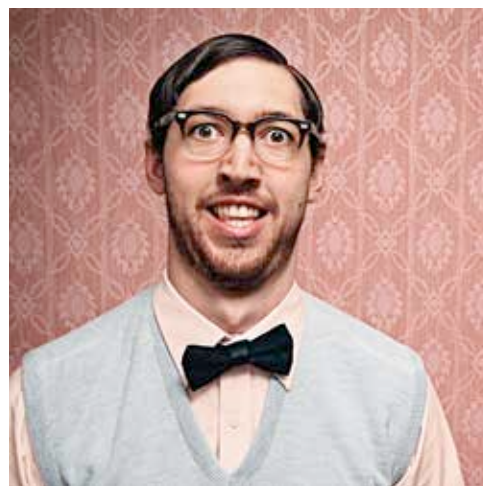
NERDS AND GEEKS: WHAT ARE THE DIFFERENCES?

While geeks are individuals who are extremely knowledgeable about a certain topic and have immense love for it, which can sometimes

be obsessive, they are not the same as nerds. Earlier, people attributed individuals who were associated with computers and computer technology as geeky individuals. However, like the example of the sports geek we gave earlier, even someone possessing extraordinary knowledge about cars or video games may be considered a <that vertical> geek. Which is great! We geeks are an inclusive lot. The more the merrier.

On the other hand, the other not-so-popular label which people shy away from is nerds. Nerds are not to be confused with geeks and the moniker is given to individuals who are unattractive, irritating, and lacking social skills. They may or may not possess a brilliant mind. They are usually isolated and introverts, who spend most of their time inside their own rooms than they do meeting and talking with others.

The Oxford English Dictionary defines a nerd as “a foolish or contemptible person who lacks social skills or is boringly studious.” However, nerds too can be defined as “single-minded expert” in a specific tech area.



Geek: May the force be with you!

Nerd: Force is equal to mass x acceleration